

Sense-Respond Loop

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Continuous adaptation to signals

PROFESSIONAL DEFINITION

The Sense-Respond Loop is a model of continuous adaptation in which an organisation senses signals from its environment and responds rapidly, iterating rather than executing a fixed long-range plan.

WHO DEVELOPED IT

Articulated by Stephan Haeckel in Adaptive Enterprise (1999) as an alternative to make-and-sell models.

WHY IT WAS DEVELOPED

It was developed for environments too turbulent for predictive planning, where responsiveness beats forecasting.

FIGURE 1 · SENSE-RESPOND LOOP

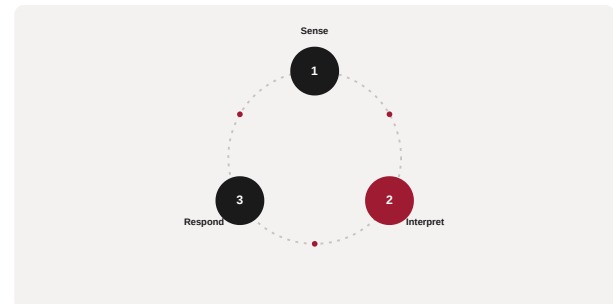


Figure 1. A schematic of the Sense-Respond Loop as applied in BARBM312 (illustrative).

HOW IT IS USED

The organisation builds capability to sense early and respond fast, treating strategy as continuous adaptation.

WHEN IT IS USED

In volatile markets and during AI-driven disruption.

BY WHOM IT IS USED

Strategists and operating leaders.

INNOVATION RELATIVE TO THE PREDECESSOR TOOL

It reframes strategy from prediction to adaptation, aligning with agile and OODA thinking under uncertainty.

RELATED FRAMEWORKS IN THIS COURSE

OODA Loop (Enterprise) · Slibrary 17

Cynefin Framework · Slibrary 17

Agile Operating Model · Slibrary 17

Real Options Lens · Slibrary 17

SOURCES (HARVARD REFERENCING STYLE)

Haeckel, S.H. (1999) Adaptive Enterprise: Creating and Leading Sense-and-Respond Organizations. Boston: HBS Press.

Reeves, M., Levin, S. and Ueda, D. (2016) 'The biology of corporate survival', Harvard Business Review, 94(1).